

Dr. Sven Hegewald

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Department of Social Sciences
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Research Interests

Political Behavior, Comparative Politics, Political Geography, European Politics.

Academic Employment

since 04/2026	POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER, Department of Social Sciences, University of Hamburg.
11/2025 – 03/2026	POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER, Institute of Political Science, Chemnitz University of Technology.
08/2024 – 10/2025	POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER, European Politics Research Group, Center for Comparative and International Studies, ETH Zurich.
09/2020 – 07/2024	DOCTORAL RESEARCHER, European Politics Research Group, Center for Comparative and International Studies, ETH Zurich.
09/2019 – 12/2019	RESEARCH INTERN, VU Interdisciplinary Center for European Studies, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam.
10/2018 – 09/2019	RESEARCH ASSISTANT, Department of Political Science, University of Amsterdam.
09/2017 – 02/2018	RESEARCH ASSISTANT, Department of Political Science, Maastricht University.

Education

09/2020 – 07/2024	DR. SC., Political Science, ETH Zurich. First advisor: Frank Schimmelfennig. Second advisor: Silja Häusermann. Committee: Ruth Dassonneville, Liesbet Hooghe.
01/2023 – 07/2023	VISITING RESEARCH STUDENT, University of Oxford. Host: Tarik Abou-Chadi.
09/2022 – 12/2022	VISITING FELLOW, Bocconi University. Host: Catherine de Vries.
09/2018 – 08/2020	M.Sc., Social Sciences (Research), University of Amsterdam. Passed with cum laude, highest honor.
09/2015 – 08/2018	B.A., European Studies, Maastricht University.

Additional Training

- 03/2023 CAUSAL SOLUTIONS: Difference-in-Differences Designs.
Instructor: Pedro H. C. Sant’Anna.
- 08/2022 ECPR VIRTUAL SUMMER SCHOOL: Machine Learning with Big Data for Social Scientists.
Instructor: Akitaka Matsuo.
- 08/2022 ESSEX SUMMER SCHOOL IN SOCIAL SCIENCE DATA ANALYSIS: Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation.
Instructor: Adam Zelizer.

Publications

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

9. **Hegewald, S.** (2026). [The Urban–Rural Divide in People’s Minds: Stereotypes of Urbanites and Ruralites in Nine European Countries](#). *Political Behavior* (Online First).
8. Malet, G., & **Hegewald, S.** (2025). [The Changing Geography of Support for European Integration in the Shadow of the Ukraine War](#). *Journal of European Public Policy* (Online First).
7. **Hegewald, S.**, & Schraff, D. (2025). [Is the Urban-Rural Divide Affectively Polarised? Comparative Evidence From Nine European Countries](#). *Comparative Political Studies* (Online First).
6. Schraff, D., & **Hegewald, S.** (2025). [Ethnic Diversity and the Societal Response to the Arrival of the Covid-19 Pandemic](#). *European Political Science Review*, 17(1), 99–109.
5. **Hegewald, S.**, & Schraff, D. (2024). [Corruption and Trust in the European Parliament: Quasi-Experimental Evidence From the Qatargate Scandal](#). *European Journal of Political Research*, 63(4), 1674–1685.
4. **Hegewald, S.** (2024). [Locality As a Safe Haven: Place-Based Resentment and Political Trust in Local and National Institutions](#). *Journal of European Public Policy*, 31(6), 1749–1774.
3. **Hegewald, S.**, & Schraff, D. (2024). [Who Rallies Around the Flag? Evidence From Panel Data During the Covid-19 Pandemic](#). *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*, 34(1), 158–179.
2. Vergioglou, I., & **Hegewald, S.** (2023). [From Causes to Consequences: Investigating the Effects of Differentiated Integration on Citizens’ EU Support](#). *European Union Politics*, 24(1), 206–224.
1. Bijsmans, P., Schakel, A.H., Baykal, A., & **Hegewald, S.** (2022). [Internationalisation and Study Success: Class Attendance and the Delicate Balance Between Collaborative Learning and Being Lost in Translation](#). *European Journal of Higher Education*, 12(3), 314–331.

POLICY PAPERS

2. Vandenbroucke, F., Burgoon, B., Kuhn, T., Nicoli, F., Sacchi, S., van der Duin, D., & **Hegewald, S.** (2018). *Risk Sharing When Unemployment Hits: How Policy Design Influences Citizen Support for European Unemployment Risk Sharing (EURS)*. Amsterdam: Amsterdam Institute for Social Science Research (AISSR).
1. Schakel, A. H., Danailova, A., Gein, I., & **Hegewald, S.** (2018). *Final Report on Updating the Regional Authority Index (RAI) for 45 Countries (2010-2016)*. Brussels: European Commission.

WORKING PAPERS

[The Effects of Territorial Reforms on Political Disaffection](#) (with Michael A. Strebel).
Revise and Resubmit: *American Political Science Review*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Positive Roots of Localism: How Place-Based Identity Drives the Preference for Hometown Candidates (with Julia Schulte-Cloos).

The Effect of Regional Accents on Voting Behavior: Experimental Evidence From Germany.

Do Stringent Climate Policies Influence Rural Political Attitudes and Behavior? Evidence From the Nitrogen Crisis in the Netherlands (with Tarik Abou-Chadi and Diane Bolet).

Imagined Political Geographies: Political Misperceptions and Affective Polarization Along the Urban-Rural Divide (with Dominik Schraff).

When the Springs Run Dry: Local Electoral Consequences of a German Spending Reform (with Michael Bayerlein, Lukas Haffert and Dominik Schraff).

Rooted or Routed: Residential Mobility and the Cosmopolitan-Communitarian Divide (with Arndt Leininger).

No Snow No Show: Climate Change, Ski Lift Closures and Community Life in Switzerland (with Daniel Auer and Jana Lipps).

Conferences

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| 2026 | DVPW AK Wahlen, DVPW SekMethoden, EPSS. |
| 2025 | DVPW AK Wahlen, EPSA, MPSA. |
| 2024 | DVPW, EPSA, SVPW. |
| 2023 | APSA, CES, EPSA, MPSA, SVPW. |
| 2022 | APSA, ECPR, ECPR SGEU, EPSA, MPSA, SVPW. |
| 2021 | EPSA, ECPR, ECPR Joint Sessions, SVPW. |

Workshops and Invited Talks

- 2026 Political Dynamics in the Knowledge Economy, **Goethe University Frankfurt**; Place-Based Identities and Polarization, **St Antony's College, University of Oxford**; LoPaPol, **TU Darmstadt**.
- 2025 DEC Workshop on Political Behavior and Public Opinion, **Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona**; Research Group Seminar, **University of Amsterdam**.
- 2024 Democracy Studies Forum, **University of Zurich**; Political Science Departmental Seminar, **Aalborg University**.
- 2023 A Space for 'Place' in the Social Sciences, **Sciences Po Paris**; Research on Rural-Urban Divides Final Conference, **Goethe University Frankfurt**; Fall Academy: Challenging Inequalities II, **University of Konstanz**; Regional Inequalities in Labour Markets and Politics, **University of Lausanne**; Inequality and Political Behaviour: Voters, Parties, and Policies, **Nuffield College, University of Oxford**; Political Science Departmental Seminar, **University of Mainz**.
- 2022 Regional Inequality and Political Discontent in Europe, **Copenhagen Business School**; Politics & Institutions Clinic, **Bocconi University**; PhD Workshop on the Comparative Politics of Europe, **European University Institute**.
- 2021 Exploring the Link Between Inequality and Euroscepticism, **Copenhagen Business School**.

Grants and Awards

- 2025 Shortlisted for the ECPR Rising Star Award.
- 2024 Nominated for the ETH Zurich Medal (Dissertation Award).
- 2023 CIS Collaboration Grant (with Mingyi Zhang). Center for Comparative and International Studies, ETH Zurich and University of Zurich (CHF 8'650).
- 2023 SNSF Mobility Grant. Swiss National Science Foundation (CHF 18'400).
- 2018 Prize for Best BA Thesis in European Studies. Stichting Wetenschapsbeoefening, Maastricht University (EUR 500).

Reviews

- Journals British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, Electoral Studies, European Journal of Political Research, European Policy Analysis, European Sociological Review, European Union Politics, Governance, Government and Opposition, Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties, Journal of European Public Policy, Journal of Trust Research, Party Politics, Political Behavior, Political Geography, Political Research Exchange, Political Studies, Publius: The Journal of Federalism, Regional & Federal Studies, Scandinavian Political Studies, Swiss Political Science Review, West European Politics.

Grant Schemes Austrian Science Fund (FWF), Polish National Science Foundation (NCN).

Teaching Experience

- Spring 2025 Political Systems and Theories II. Undergraduate Tutorial, BA Political Science, University of Zurich.
Contemporary European Politics. Undergraduate Seminar, Science in Perspective, ETH Zurich.
- Fall 2024 Methods I: Research Design, Qualitative Methods, and Data Collection. Graduate Seminar, MACIS, ETH Zurich.
Political Systems and Theories I. Undergraduate Tutorial, BA Political Science, University of Zurich.
- Spring 2024 Political Systems and Theories II. Undergraduate Tutorial, BA Political Science, University of Zurich.
Contemporary European Politics. Undergraduate Seminar, Science in Perspective, ETH Zurich.
- Fall 2023 Political Systems and Theories I. Undergraduate Tutorial, BA Political Science, University of Zurich.
- Spring 2022 Contemporary European Politics. Undergraduate Seminar, Science in Perspective, ETH Zurich.
- Fall 2021 Methods I: Research Design, Qualitative Methods, and Data Collection. Graduate Tutorial, MACIS, ETH Zurich
- Spring 2021 Contemporary European Politics. Undergraduate Seminar, Science in Perspective, ETH Zurich.

Didactical Training

- 11/2024 INSPIRA FOR BEGINNERS. 2-hour workshop. IT Training, University of Zurich.
- 10/2021 FACILITATING EFFECTIVE DISCUSSIONS. One-day workshop. Didactica, ETH Zurich.
- 09/2021–12/2021 LEARNING TO TEACH. 60-hour course. 60-hour course. Educational Development and Technology, ETH Zurich.

Languages

German (native), English (fluent), French (basic).

Software

R (advanced), $\text{\LaTeX}$ (advanced), Python (basic), Stata (basic).